

e you to a list of all possible fields you can add to the column list

1. Search and add any additional fields you want to see (a common column to add that is not included by default is "Next Task Due Date")

1. Click "Apply" to save your changes to the view (you can do this as many times as you want to test out different column fields)

To create and save a customized CTA view for yourself beyond the defaults, use the filter button at the top right; you can later access these views in the dropdown at the top left.

Once you have your Cockpit customized to your needs, you can also sort the rows by a column field by clicking on the name of a column, e.g. "Due Date".

Please note that any customizations you do for a Cockpit view will be consistent between the main Cockpit and individual C360 Cockpits.

Types of CTAs

There are several "types" of CTAs, which will have different corresponding playbooks, so if you're looking for a particular playbook be sure to select the appropriate type. See below for each type and the corresponding playbooks for that type.

- Risk
 - At-Risk
 - DevSecOps Risk
 - Low License Utilization
 - Non-Engaged Customer
 - Product Risk
 - Risk Escalation
 - Scale NPS Detractor
- Expansion (no playbooks associated)
- Lifecycle
 - Create Success Plan
 - Customer Offboarding
 - Executive Business Review (EBR)
 - Existing Customer Onboarding
 - High License Utilization
 - New Customer Onboarding
 - New Customer Onboarding - SaaS email assist
 - New Customer Onboarding - Self-Managed email assist
 - Usage Data Enablement
 - Webinar Attended by Customer
- Activity
 - New Account Handoff
- Renewal
 - Upcoming Renewal
- Digital Journey
 - Digital Adoption - CI Enablement
 - Digital Onboarding - SaaS Email Series
 - Digital Onboarding - Self-Managed Alternative Backup Strategies
 - Digital Onboarding - Self-Managed Email Series

- Digital Onboarding - Welcome Email
- Scale: 21 Day Post Onboarding - Calendly Clicked
- Scale: 21 Day Post Onboarding - Calendly Not Clicked
- Scale: 6 Month Check-in - Calendly Clicked
- Scale: 6 Month Check-in - Calendly Not Clicked
- Scale: Low License Utilization - Calendly Clicked
- Scale: Low License Utilization - Calendly Not Clicked
- Scale: One-Off Scale CSM Outreach
- Scale Team: Day 14 Reach-Out
- CSM Account Transitions

If the CTA you're opening does not fall into one of the playbook categories, choose the type that makes the most sense. If it's a common CTA, suggest creating a playbook for the it by opening an issue.

CTA Status

CTA statuses are defined below.

Available on All CTAs:

- New - Brand new CTA, has yet to be started
- Work in progress - CTA currently being worked on by a CSM
- Closed Success - This CTA was completed with a positive (or intended) outcome
- Closed Lost: Not a Priority - Customer doesn't see this as a top objective to pursue
- Closed: Already Solved
- Closed: Not Relevant
- Closed: Lack of Engagement

Available on Lifecycle CTAs only:

- Closed: Not needed

Available on Objective CTAs only (Success Plans):

- Closed Lost: Competitive Loss - This is explicitly when a customer is exploring solutions for additional use cases and selects another net-new vendor. This situation does not include losing out to the incumbent, which speaks more to didn't see the value.
- Closed Lost: Product Gaps - In reviewing the use case and features/capabilities, there were product gaps, or the customer believes the product does not meet their use case needs.
- Closed Lost: Responsible Team Unengaged - Another team other than the one we are engaged with owns the capability or permission needed for adoption. We have not been successful in engaging this other team.
- Closed Lost: Didn't See Value - Customer did not see the value to justify the investment, assuming the ability to drive adoption was within their scope of control.
- Closed Lost: Deferred To Later Date - The customer has shown material interest (i.e., committed, high-level of interest) in expanding but prefers to pursue at a different date. CSM in these instances creates a reminder CTA to bring the conversation back up.
- Closed Lost: Lack of Budget - Customer would need to up-tier to use the new stage in full and does not have the budget available.

Snoozing CTAs

In Gainsight, you are able to snooze a CTA in order to keep it open but remove it from your main Cockpit until a later date (it will still show up in the C360 Cockpit).

Reasons to snooze a CTA instead of closing it:

1. The CTA isn't applicable at this point in time, but will be applicable in the foreseeable future. For example, if an account is newly CSM-qualifying and you receive a CTA to hold an EBR, use the snooze CTA functionality to push out the date within the next 3-6 months.
1. Ensure a similar/related CTA isn't fired. For example, if a CTA fires when you haven't updated CSM Sentiment, but you have a cadence call scheduled for next week, you can snooze the CTA for a week from now and avoid getting another CTA before you can meet with the customer.

To snooze a CTA, follow these instructions:

1. Open the CTA
1. Click the three vertical dots
1. Click Snooze
1. Select a date for the CTA snooze to end, and select a reason for snoozing
1. Click Snooze

To update either Snooze Date or Snooze Reason, or to manually un-snooze the CTA, go to the CTA and click the three vertical dots again and change the details as required.

When a CTA is snoozed, it will not appear in the main Cockpit until the snooze ends or they are un-snoozed, but you can view snoozed CTAs by going to the C360 Cockpit which will show all CTAs. You can also update your main Cockpit filter to show snoozed CTAs by selecting the filter icon in the upper right corner and marking the Is Snoozed filter as true.

To request additional Snooze options, please open an issue in the Gainsight issue tracker.

For more information and illustrations, review Gainsight's documentation and Task Detail Views How to Use the Snooze Option).

SECTION: customer-success/csm/gainsight/dashboards-overview.md

For an overview of Gainsight, and information about how to login, please refer to the Gainsight Overview Page.

For an overview of how CSMs use Gainsight, please refer to the Gainsight CSM Overview Page

Gainsight dashboard

When logging in, CSMs will begin on their dashboard. Gainsight's homepage will show a "My Portfolio" Dashboard which is a full list and overview of each CSM's customers. This dashboard defaults to show the book of business for the current user but can be filtered and configured in a variety of ways to view the information for specific CSMs, teams, etc.

This view is likely to be a CSM's most-frequented page, as it shows a summary of their entire book of business, including last activity dates, health scores, at-risk customers, upcoming renewals, stage adoption statistics, and more.

There are also other dashboards available to CSMs to look at, including the CS Leadership Dashboard which reviews aspects of all CSM-supported accounts.

When hovering on the far left of the screen, a sidebar will pop up that has a few options:

- Home - you're here!
- Timeline - this Timeline view shows all customers, rather than an individual customer which can be found on a Customer 360.
- Cockpit - the Cockpit is where CTAs live; this Cockpit view shows all CTAs for all of your customers, including success plan objectives.

Further detail on specific dashboards

1. CSM Burn-Down Dashboard
1. CSM Key Metrics Dashboard

SECTION: customer-success/csm/gainsight/dashboards.md

Specific detail on various Gainsight dashboards

Below are select dashboards, with descriptions of what each widget on the dashboards means, in order to help Gainsight users understand what the information is telling them and what action, if any, is required.

CSM Burn-Down Dashboard

Onboarding

1. 1st Engage >14

1. Count of customers who have not had a Timeline entry logged more than 14 days since their onboarding CTA start date

1. 1st Value >30 Days

1. Count of customers who have not achieved Known License Utilization of $\geq 10\%$, or the CSM has manually logged a First Value Date if usage data is unavailable, by more than 30 days since their original contract date

1. Total Onboard > 45 Days

1. Count of customers who have open onboarding CTAs that have been open for more than 45 days

Engagement

1. PR1 Cadence >30 Days

1. Count of P1 customers who have not had a logged Timeline activity within the past 30 days

1. PR2 Cadence >60 Days

1. Count of P2 customers who have not had a logged Timeline activity within the past 60 days

1. CSM Sentiment >90 Days

1. Count of customers who have not had the CSM Sentiment healthscore updated within the past 90 days

1. Non-Green Success Plans (PR1/PR2)

1. Count of customers who do not have a green success plan, categorized into P1 and P2 buckets

1. PR1 Success Plans: No Activity >60 days

1. Count of P1 customers who have not had activity/updates in their success plans within the past 60 days

1. PR1 - No EBR in 12 Months

1. Count of P1 customers who have not had an EBR logged in Timeline within the past 12 months

1. Green PR1 Success Plans: 0 Objectives

1. Count of P1 success plans that are otherwise green but do not have any open objectives

1. PR1 SP Percentage by CSM Team

1. Percentage breakdown of Success Plans by Account Health, Green, Yellow, and Red

Enablement & Expansion

1. Stage Adoption: No Activity >60 Days

1. Count of customers who have open stage adoption CTAs that have not had activity/updates within the past 60 days

1. Stage Adoption >175 Days Total Age

1. Count of customers who have open stage adoption CTAs that are over 175 days old

1. Pr1 No GitLab Admin Assigned

1. Count of P1 customers who do not have a GitLab Admin persona assigned in the contact list

1. Pr2 No GitLab Admin Assigned

1. Count of P2 customers who do not have a GitLab Admin persona assigned in the contact list

Risk

1. N/A Risk Impact

1. Customers who are at risk but do not have the Risk Impact field defined in the CTA details

1. N/A Risk Reason

1. Customers who are at risk but do not have the Risk Reason field defined in the CTA details

1. No Risk Update >35 Days

1. Customers who are at risk but do not have a Risk update on the Timeline within the past 35 days

Product Usage Data

1. Unknown Instances - CSM Owned

1. Count of self-managed customers who have instances populated but are not labeled

CSM Proactive Dashboard

Upcoming this Month

1. Cadence Calls Due:

1. Count of P1 customers that haven't had a Timeline Entry with Meeting type: Cadence Call in the past 30 days and P2 Customers in the past 60 days

1. Upcoming CTAs:

1. Count of all New/Work in Progress CTAs that are due in the next 30 days

1. Upcoming Success Plan Tasks:

1. Count of open success plan tasks due in the next 30 days. Does not include any overdue CTAs

1. Upcoming EBRs for Scheduling:

1. Count of active EBRs that are due in the next 30 days. Does not look at overdue CTAs

Upcoming This Quarter

1. Upcoming Success Plan Objectives:

1. Open/WIP Objectives due this fiscal year, not including any that are past their due date.

1. Upcoming Stage Expansion:

1. Count of open/WIP expansion stage adoption objectives due over the current quarter

1. Upcoming Stage Enablement:

1. Count of open/WIP enablement stage adoption objectives due over the current quarter

1. Upcoming Renewals

1. Count of renewal opportunities with ARR > 50000 that aren't closed or unqualified with a close date in the current quarter

1. Upcoming Upsell Due to Close

1. Count of "add-on business" opportunities that aren't closed but have a close date in the current quarter

Health and Utilization

1. High License Utilization

1. Count of customers whose License Utilization exceeds 90%

1. License Utilization Health

1. Bar chart comparing License Utilization Health across selected filters, which varies depending on how long they've been a customer.

1. Details on how License Utilization is measured here: Customer Health Assessment and Management - License Usage Health Table

1. CI Adoption Health

1. Bar chart comparing CI Adoption Health across selected filters.

1. Details on how CI Adoption is measured here: Customer Use Case Adoption

1. Customers Using Secure

1. This report shows a customer's usage of Free/Premium scanning features such as SAST, Container Scanning, and Secret Detection. This should allow CSMs to gauge the customer's interest in DevSecOps and prompt conversations around up-tiering to Ultimate.

CSM Key Metrics Dashboard

This dashboard is a means for the CSMs to easily answer: 'how I am doing towards our team/individual metric goals?' This dashboard also gives insight on performance against metrics for FY22 president's club. For FY22 the president club metrics for CSMs are:

1. Percentage of accounts with green success plans
1. Percentage of accounts with EBRs completed
1. Percentage of accounts with stage adoption initiatives completed (enable & expand)
1. Contribution to ARR growth (not shown in this dashboard)

1st Section Reports

1. Account Breakdown by CSM and Priority
 1. Count of P1, P2 and P3 customers per CSM
2. Percentage Green SPs by All Accounts
 1. For all accounts by CSM, the percentage of green success plans
3. Percentage EBRs by all Accounts
 1. For all accounts by CSM, the percentage of successful EBRs
4. Percentage Closed Stage Enablement CTAs
 1. For all accounts by CSM, the percentage of closed stage enablement CTAs
5. Percentage Open Stage Enablement CTAs
 1. For all accounts by CSM, the percentage of open stage enablement CTAs
6. Percentage Closed Expansion CTAs
 1. For all accounts by CSM, the percentage of closed stage expansion CTAs
7. Percentage Open Expansion CTAs
 1. For all accounts by CSM, the percentage of open stage expansion CTAs

P1 Accounts - 2nd Section

1. Percentage of Accounts with Green SPs PR1
 1. For all P1 accounts by CSM, the percentage of green success plans
2. Percentage EBRs by CSM PR1
 1. For all P1 accounts by CSM, the percentage of successful EBRs
3. Percentage Closed Stage Enablement CTAs PR1
 1. For all P1 accounts by CSM, the percentage of closed stage enablement CTAs
4. Percentage Open Stage Enablement CTAs PR1
 1. For all P1 accounts by CSM, the percentage of open stage enablement CTAs
5. Percentage Closed Expansion CTAs PR1
 1. For all P1 accounts by CSM, the percentage of closed stage expansion CTAs
6. Percentage Open Stage Expansion CTAs PR1
 1. For all P1 accounts by CSM, the percentage of closed stage expansion CTAs

SECTION: customer-success/csm/gainsight/deployment-types.md

Customer Deployment Types

During customer onboarding, these fields should be filled out in Gainsight. Deployment types

definitions for customer attributes on the Gainsight C360:

Customer Conversion Source

The purpose is understanding where the customer came from · this is about sourcing (e.g., marketing/SDR'ing as an analogy). Each customer should fit into one of three buckets regardless of when they started using GitLab:

- Community conversion (first value waived) - A customer who was using the free community version and is converting (or converted) to a paid subscription tier.
- New Customer - This is a brand new customer who doesn't (or didn't) have an existing GitLab deployment.
- Existing - New CSM (first value waived) - The customer was already a paying customer and is being (or was) assigned a CSM (e.g., upgraded from a small deployment to large).

Hosting

What is the customer's main deployment type?

- Self-managed - on-premises
- Self-managed - cloud
- Self-managed - hybrid
- GitLab.com
- Self-managed and GitLab.com

Deployer

Addresses the question of who did the work to deploy them?

- Customer-deployed
- GitLab services
- Partner services

Provider

Logs what (cloud) provider the customer uses or if they're on-premises

- On-Premise
- AWS
- GCP
- Azure
- GitLab.com
- Multi-cloud
- Other

SECTION: customer-success/csm/gainsight/timeline.md

The Timeline view in Gainsight gives us a chronological overview of our activities with the

customer. It's a valuable tool to see our interactions and progression on success efforts over time.

Timeline Views

- Global Timeline: When going to the timeline from the lefthand sidebar (not for a specific customer), you will see the global timeline, which is all timeline events for all CSMs. From there, you can filter by clicking the three horizontal lines to customize what events are shown (see picture below). For example, you can search for yourself as the author to find all timeline events you created, or you can search for a company to find all timeline events for a specific customer.
- Customer 360 Page: You can access a specific customer's timeline by navigating to their customer 360 page, then clicking on the Timeline tab at the top. From here you can sort and filter by type, date, etc.
- CTA View: When you click on the details of a specific CTA or success plan Objective, there is a Timeline tab. You can add entries from here that will be linked to the CTA. These timeline entries will also appear on the company and global timelines.

Activity types

The following activities can be logged in Gainsight and automatically sync-ed to Salesforce:

- Customer Call: Conversation with the customer using Zoom or other synchronous channel.
- Update: General update on the customer, could be from an internal conversation.
- In-Person Meeting: On-site or otherwise in-person meeting with the customer.
- Email: Message sent to the customer, or message thread between the CSM and the customer.
- Health Update: An update on the customer, could be from an internal conversation and used exclusively with red customers for providing updates specific to a risk. See At-Risk CTA for details.
- Workshop: A customer workshop, which can include GitLab Days, Workshops, Lunch and & Learns, and more.
- CSE Engagement: Conversation with a CSE/Scale customer using Zoom or other synchronous channel.
- CSA Engagement: Used to track CSA engagements aligned with a Success Services engagement.
- Verified Outcomes: An activity type used to provide an update regarding work aligned with a customer verified outcome.
- At-Risk/Escalation: An update on the customer, could be from an internal conversation. This timeline entry type is part of a process to push update notifications to the Escalations Slack channel for visibility and collaboration.

Gong Recordings

When Gong is used to record a call, a record is created in Gainsight Timeline. CSMs can edit these activities and add additional information such as External Attendees, CSM Sentiment, etc.

Note: these activities will only count towards the Last Activity Date and the Engagement score

if they are created by the CSM (or in other words, if the CSM was the owner of the Gong call).

Last Activity Date

The "Last Activity Date" field in the customer's record reflects the latest "Call" or "Meeting" activity entry to be logged for the customer. These are the only entry types that affect Last Activity Date since we want to track when we are having synchronous conversations with the customer.

Please note it may take up to 2 hours after logging a timeline event before the "Last Activity Date" is updated.

Related, there is the "Last Timeline Activity" which looks to any and all activities on the timeline (update, email, call...).

How to Log Activities in Timeline

You can log activities to Timeline in multiple places across Gainsight.

Tip: When searching for external attendees, you can use "%%%" as your search pattern to list all contacts of an account. This is useful, if you do not remember all participants by name from your activity like cadence call or similar.

Global Timeline

1. Navigate to the global timeline by clicking on the left navigation bar icon
2. Click on "Add Activity" and choose the appropriate activity type
3. Search for and confirm the account name in the "Company/Relationship" box

Follow the rest of the steps below

Customer 360 Timeline

1. Navigate to the customer 360 page
1. Click the Timeline tab at the top
1. Click on "Add Activity" and choose the appropriate activity type

Follow the rest of the steps below

CTA/Objective Timeline

1. Navigate to the specific CTA or success plan objective
1. Click on the subject to get the details sidebar
1. Click on the Timeline tab
1. Click on the + icon and choose the appropriate activity type

Follow the rest of the steps below

1. Input a subject
1. Confirm the date (it will default to when you clicked "+ Activity") and time (this does not

need to be the exact time of the activity as long as the date is correct) if applicable

1. Add internal and external attendees (more details on that immediately below) if applicable

1. Choose the meeting type if applicable

1. Check off if an executive sponsor attended if applicable

1. Optionally update the CSM and Product sentiments to reflect health score

1. Add "Milestone Type" if applicable

1. Add notes (e.g. a link to the Google doc of your cadence call, a summary of health score change, etc.)

1. Add any action items as "tasks"

The other options to log activities are (1) on the Scorecard while recording CSM Sentiment or Product Risk or (2) on the Success Plan to log a Timeline activity specific to the plan.

Attendees will only appear if they are a) a Salesforce user for internal attendees, or b) a contact in the Salesforce account record. If your internal attendee does not have a SFDC account (e.g. Support Engineers or Product Designers), you do not need to log them and can just mention in the notes they were there. If your external attendee is not populating, make sure that they are added to the correct account (child accounts have different contact lists than their parent accounts), and if not feel free to add them by clicking the "Add Contact" button in Salesforce and inputting the required details. New SFDC contacts most likely won't populate in Gainsight until the following day, so this is a great opportunity to create a CTA for yourself!

If you would like to see the activity logging process in action, please watch the enablement video that covers logging.

Syncing Salesforce Activities

Gainsight Timeline also displays the following Salesforce activities. While these are synced, they do not impact CSM health scorecards, Last Activity Date, or Last Timeline Activity since Salesforce activities are typically sales-related.

- Source:
 - Opportunities
 - Accounts
- Type:
 - Included: Call, Demo, Workshop
 - Purposefully excluded: Email and Other
 - There are certain email activities classified as Other thus why they're excluded (noise to signal)

Limitations

- Any Salesforce activity that does not have any content in the description
 - Example: a call with a subject and no body will fail to sync

BCCing Emails

While we recommend BCCing emails to Salesforce instead of to Gainsight, you can do the same with Gainsight. To get your personalize email address, navigate to your settings:

1. Click the person icon in the upper right
1. Click "My Settings"
1. Navigate to "Inbound Emails" and copy the email address (Tip: save it as an email contact for easy reference)

BCCing emails to Gainsight is not a required step. However, if you want an email to appear in both Gainsight and Salesforce, you will need to BCC Gainsight.

1. Emails logged in Salesforce stay in Salesforce
1. Emails logged in Gainsight appear in Gainsight and then are synced to Salesforce during the nightly sync

For more information on using emails with Gainsight, see the Gainsight workflow handbook page.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/health-score-triage/index.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

This page covers the factors to consider for customer health, guidelines for selecting the appropriate rating, communication guidelines, CSM responsibilities and instructions for the account triage issue creation.

See Customer Health Scoring for an overview on how customer health scoring is defined and calculated at GitLab.

CSM Responsibilities

The CSM is responsible for coordinating with all relevant parties to develop a plan to address account risks. Typically, this will involve the account team and communication group (Communication Guidelines), as well as other relevant stakeholders such as Product Managers, marketing, executive, or engineering team members to develop and deliver the plan to address the risks. The CSM then drives execution of the strategy and is responsible for logging regular updates. When the risks have been addressed bringing the customer to a healthy / green status, the account team can agree to move the account out of triage.

Tracking Customer Health

CSMs can use Red, Yellow, and Green to reflect their sentiment of a customer's health. Below is an explanation about how to think about a customer's health.

Green

Customer is very likely to renew and/or expand with no known or assumed risk of downsell or churn. Customer's experience: engagement, adoption and experiences are as expected or better than expected, delivering value and outcomes as appropriate the customer's stage in their journey. Examples:

- Progressive adoption of GitLab use cases as defined by their success plan, considering their stage in their journey
- Alignment with stakeholders who can drive desired outcomes
- Regular communication and engagement in meetings
- Positive feedback on the product and experience and/or high scores on NPS surveys
- Leveraging support services as defined by creation of tickets (1-5 tickets per month)
- Interest in providing feedback and engaging with GitLab through other programs and events (e.g., Commit, CAB)

Yellow & Yellow "Needs Triage"

Potential risk or significant lack of information leading to uncertainty. Indicates challenges to overcome, with a lower risk of churn or downsell. Customer's experience: engagement, adoption and/or experiences are lower than expected, risking GitLab's ability to deliver customer value and outcomes and/or drive future revenue growth. Examples:

- Slow, delayed, or blocked adoption of GitLab use cases in support of the customer's success plan
- Customer lacks definition of goals or success criteria
- High number of support cases, critical / blocker product issue(s), or poor experience based on the customer's expectations
- Lack of engagement, responsiveness or participation in meetings and/or events
- Loss of sponsor or champion due to change of role or organization or acquisition
- Lack of adoption of releases (self-managed only) where they are more than a major release behind the current release
- Not leveraging technical support services or has a large number of cases and/or high severity cases (6-15 tickets per month, or no ticket(s) opened after being advised by the CSM that Support is the best path to resolution for an issue(s))
- Poor experiences with Support, Professional Services or another part of GitLab
- Working with a single contact at a company (single-threaded).

There might be well understood reasons within the account team why a customer is flagged as Yellow within the current phase of the customer lifecycle. If the CSM decides that corrective actions and follow up from team members outside of the CSM group is required the CSM must create an At Risk Timeline Entry.

Red

Specific, known risks to account retention or upcoming opportunity, or overwhelming lack of information, such as unresponsiveness leading up to renewal. Customer's experience: engagement, adoption and/or experiences are significantly lower than expected where issues are blocking GitLab's ability to deliver expected value, outcomes, or positive experiences as defined by the customer.

Examples:

- Potential risk of contraction or churn (even if this is unconfirmed)
- Lack of alignment with stakeholders who can drive outcomes...
 - Economic Buyer
 - Champion
 - Key Personas

- Cameron (Compliance Manager)
- Delaney (Development Team Lead)
- Product does not deliver expected value or outcomes as defined by success plan
- No or low product adoption with no progression
- Communication of poor sentiment
- Lack of any engagement
- Significantly poor experiences with Support or Professional Services
- Significant number of support tickets (16+ per month)

Will Churn

Very rarely, a customer reaches a point at which it is accepted by the account team and leadership that a customer will contract or churn. As Gainsight does not support a 'grey' color (or any color outside of the standard green to red health scoring), the will churn lifecycle stage can be applied in 360° Attributes.

In order for a customer to move to the will churn stage, the following must be completed:

1. All options discussed during the health reviews have been exhausted
1. CSM discusses it with their manager and gets agreement on moving to will churn
1. RM/AE marks the opportunity as Will Churn or Will Contract
1. CSM updates the Lifecycle Stage in Gainsight C360 > Attributes > Lifecycle Stage to Will Churn

Reporting and Viewing Customer Health

Use the Customer Health (CSM Portfolio Dashboard) report to view the health of every measure for your customers in one single view.

To view Timeline entries where the CSM Sentiment was updated:

1. Go to Global Timeline
1. Filter by Sentiment = Green, Yellow, or Red
1. Apply any other specific filters (CSM Name, Timeline date, etc)

Gainsight Responsibilities

CSMs are responsible for keeping Gainsight up to date regarding all of their account risks.

At Risk Timeline Entries

For any account that is Red or Yellow, the following steps for an At Risk timeline update is required:

1. In the account timeline, log a Health Update, marking CSM Sentiment as Red (or Yellow). Also select values for the Risk Reason and Risk Impact fields.
1. Customer Health Conclusion:
 1. Customer is won back:
 1. Log Account-level Timeline Health Update type for CSM Sentiment as Green and final notes

1. Change customer Lifecycle Stage to Adopting
1. Customer is lost:
 1. Log Account-level Timeline Health Update type with final update
 1. Change customer Lifecycle Stage to: Will Churn for a churning customer and Adopting for downgrade customer

These can then be discussed with the Account Team during account reviews.

Customer Health Update Format

The Health Update description should follow the format below. When logging the activity in Gainsight, this format can be auto-imported by clicking the "Apply Template" button on the Health Update activity.

1. What's at risk today? - 1-2 sentences describing the specific churn risk and key metrics/data points.
1. What's the mitigation plan for risk? - 1-2 sentences outlining the key actions being taken to address the risk.
1. Who owns the next step? - [Name and Role]
1. What's the timeline of the next step? - [Specific date - MM/DD/YYYY]

Here is a sample health update:

- > Risk: License utilization dropped to 35% with only 2 of 5 departments actively using the platform. Primary champion announced departure effective end of month.
- > Mitigation: Scheduling executive alignment call next week to identify new champion and launching targeted training for underutilized departments.
- > Owner: Jane Smith, CSM
- > Next Step Timeline: 06/15/2025

This format is to satisfy a few requirements:

- Clarity of situation and action up front (leading with key details)
- Ensure the most pertinent information is readily visible in other systems where it is synced and displayed
- Consistency to improve async processes

Health Update for Resolution of Risk

When a customer's risk has been mitigated and they are no longer at risk, the CSM creates a Health Update timeline entry communicating:

1. The customer is no longer at risk
1. Key details about what mitigated the risk
1. What comes next
1. CSM Sentiment updated to reflect current health status

This is to ensure that everyone is aware of the latest details, and that we affirmatively communicate risk resolution across our systems and teams.

Here is a sample entry for risk resolution:

> CUSTOMER X is no longer at risk. We resolved their upgrade and infrastructure challenges through engagement with Support and Professional Services, and they are now on the latest GitLab version with infrastructure tested using GPT. We are now focused on CI adoption, in line with the agreed-upon success plan.

Frequency of At Risk Timeline Entries

1. If customer renewal is this fiscal quarter or next:

1. Weekly Health Timeline updates

- Entry should include progress towards risk mitigation over the past week and plans for the upcoming week.

1. If customer renewal is after next fiscal quarter:

1. Monthly Health Timeline updates

- Entry should include progress towards risk mitigation over the past month and plans for the upcoming month.

When to open an Account Escalation

If a CSM has marked an account as Red and further assistance from Product, Support or Managers+ is needed, open an Account Escalation.

Risk impact definitions

1. Customer Churn - fully churn the account

1. Tier Downgrade - move down tiers

1. Seat Churn - reduce license seat count

1. Customer Sentiment (Impact Unknown) - customer is unhappy and the impact isn't quantified

1. Competitor - any competitive intelligence we might be up against

1. Stage Name - stage impact, for example, product deficiencies, direction, or needs.

Risk reason definitions

Lack of adoption

Customer never adopted the product or specific features so they did not get value. This can be because of organizational silos or lack of internal resources. If they didn't adopt because they didn't see / experience value, it should be Product Gap

Product Value / Gaps

Prospect or customer used the product and features (i.e., trial, POV, or purchased product), but did not see the value. The product did not meet requirements of the customer. This can also be a prospect where they did not experience perceived value

Product Quality / Availability

Prospect or customer used the product and features (i.e., trial, POV, or purchased product) though they did not meet the prospect or customer's needs or expectations. This can be defects, poor performance, or uptime/availability issues. Includes both self-managed and SaaS products

Lack of Engagement / Sponsor

We lost or were never able to get engagement with the prospect or customer team. The champion / sponsor left, changed responsibility, or became unresponsive. We were never able to re-establish connection with a new sponsor or champion

Loss of Budget

The prospect or customer lost budget due to business contraction, change of priorities, reduction of employees, or other. This was not a competitive loss.

Corporate Decision

Due to management decision or policy, the prospect or customer chose a different product but not because of product gaps, adoption, etc. This would be a top-down decision (e.g., ELA, decision to commit to a single provider)

- Other - other company issues that contribute to a blocker for the renewal

Mitigation Strategies

For CSM guidance on mitigating risk, please see the Risk Types, Discovery & Mitigation Strategies page.

At Risk Communication Guidelines

The following are guidelines on who to notify when an account is yellow or red. Please make sure the following people are notified with the respective customer health ratings.

Yellow Health Rating

- Account Team (i.e. Account Executive and Solution Architect)
- Regional CSM Manager
- CSM Director (all non-Public Sector customers) or Director of Customer Success Public Sector (for Public Sector customers)

Red Health Rating

- Include the list above as well as
- Area Sales Manager and Regional Director
- Vice President of Customer Success

Related Processes

Customer Success Escalations Process

SECTION: customer-success/csm/qbr/_index.md

Overview

QBRs are held the last two weeks of the quarter. It is a chance for CSMs to review performance and lessons learned from the past quarter, highlight wins and discuss goals for next quarter.

For Sales Leadership QBRs and process, please see our GitLab Field QBRs handbook page.

Slide Deck

The QBR template deck is available in the CSM QBR Google Drive (internal only).

Process

1. CSM Managers create schedule based on mixed teams. Here is an example agenda (internal only).
2. CSM Managers send out calendar invites during the last two weeks of the quarter. All presenting CSMs are invited as required, all other team members are invited as optional.
3. During the QBR sessions, there will be one CSM manager as the lead. Each assigned CSM will present their slides and leave time at the end for questions.
4. CSM Managers will send out survey at the end of QBRs to gather feedback.
5. CSM Managers iterate on slide deck for next quarter based on survey feedback. The updated deck will live in a new folder in our CSM QBR Google Drive.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/readmes/_index.md

SECTION: customer-success/csm/readmes/aleeshadawson/_index.md

About Me

Hi! My name is Aleesha Dawson. I am a mathematician by training, but consider myself a jack-of-all-trades as I have been an educator, a developer, and a customer success manager. I like to tell people "I don't know what I want to do when I grow up," and I have been lucky enough to land in this fantastic field of software where the roles are plentiful.

How I Work

I like to dive into problems, diagramming if applicable, to identify all edge cases. I like to identify bottlenecks so my teammates and I can create more efficient processes.

Communicating with Me

Although I am an introvert, I like to work synchronously if time allows. If time does not allow, back and forth through Slack (or via an Issue) comes in a close second. I prefer Slack for brainstorming or social interactions and GitLab issues for conversations where documentation would be appropriate and helpful.

Career Aspirations

For the first three years of my career, I worked as a developer for the federal government. I worked on a forward-leaning team, at times even more so than my industry colleagues. Unfortunately, bureaucracy burned me out as I realized it could quite literally take an act of Congress to change policy.

All that changed at GitLab. Since coming here, I have started initiatives to try to make my job more repeatable. I reach across departments, looking for more scalable solutions to everyday problems. I realize that here, I can create positive influence; this has lead me down a path to leadership. I was promoted from Intermediate to Senior Customer Success Manager on 8/1/2023, about a year and a half after starting, and have now set my sights to a management role. I hope to mentor fellow CSMs along the way and drive change where possible.

Strengths

- I love working with people and collaborating to solve problems, leveraging others strengths that I am lacking.
- I believe in creating efficient processes, working as a team rather than as an individual contribution.
- I earned the nickname "Cheddar Bob" during SKO in February 2023 because of my transparency and willingness to always speak up. (Read about what it means to be a "Cheddar Bob" or one of the other "C"s here.)

Weaknesses

I am certainly not without my flaws. Many of them stem from being a perfectionist and a "Cheddar Bob". I promise you I am not trying to spin a strength into a weakness. It is the side effects from those traits that become my biggest weaknesses.

- Perfectionism creates an environment where risk-taking is not an option, and as my manager and several customers have quoted to me "perfect is the enemy of good". I strive to take more risks in order to progress, but sometimes I need a little push.
- While being a "Cheddar Bob" is mostly a strength, this together with perfectionism can lead to obsessive behavior. I can get tunnel vision and decide things impulsively, especially if no one else has spoken up. However, I am sometimes the reason that no one has spoken up because I monopolize the conversation. I can miss the big picture, and sometimes need someone to pull me from the weeds.

If you notice me falling into either of these traps, feel free to call me out on it. I am not

trying to silence others; I am just passionate. Sometimes it takes me a long time to realize what I am doing it, so I need help refocusing.

Related Links

- LinkedIn
- GitLab

SECTION: customer-success/csm/readmes/ofalk/_index.md

Oliver Falk's README

Oliver Falk, Manager, Customer Success Engineering, EMEA

This page is intended to help others understand what it might be like to work with me, especially people who haven't worked with me before.

It's also a well-intentioned effort at building some trust by being intentionally vulnerable, and to share my ideas of a good working relationship to reduce the anxiety of people who might be on my team.

Please feel free to contribute to this page by opening a merge request.

Related pages

- <https://about.me/ofalk>

About me

I started with Linux a very long time ago, somewhere in the 90ties. I've been in various roles in IT, including being a systems administrator, DevOps engineer (before the term was even coined), CTO. A few years ago I decided (again) to look into people management and I completely felt in love with the topic of Customer Success, modern work, remote work and leadership.

I'm a father of twins (born 2006), a boy, Paul and a girl, Marlene. I'm married the second time and my daughter lives with me, while my son decided to live with his mother.

I grew up in Vienna and even if I keep hearing from tourists how wonderful the city is, I'd never consider going back. I love nature and the (more) silent countryside.

How you can help me

Some people call me utopist and I'm easily trapped sharing my vision of the future, please stop me and keep me to the point if necessary! I don't know if it's related, but I tend to kick off things; I even love getting projects and initiatives started and participate for a while, but in some cases I lack endurance to bring it over the finish line.

- Feedback is a gift!

- Give feedback on my ideas/visions.
- Openly share your feedback about positive and negative behavior.
- I struggle at organizing events (even smaller rounds or reserving a table somewhere). I'm pretty sure this is something I could change, but I simply don't enjoy it.

I guess this isn't an exhaustive list and I'll try to enhance it in future. If you recognize anything that is missing here, I'm happy if you help me extending it!

My working style

- Interaction in written form, asynchronously is definitely working best for me.
- If you're using abbreviations, please never assume others know what you mean. In my opinion (IMO), it works best if you write it out and add the abbreviation in parenthesis, so you can use it later in the text. But your mileage may vary (YMMV). Point is: Esp. TLAs (Three Letter Acronyms) are heavily overused these days and very often mean different things in different context. You want an example? Talk to me about a very confusing mail exchange I had about 'TAM'.
- Customer Success changed my life and I see the work different now, for me it became a passion that I'm very willing to keep pursuing and I'm not getting tired talking about it.
- I love numbers and statistics, but I'm maybe not the best in creating amazing graphs. Anyway, numbers and statistics always require context and explanation.

What I assume about others

- I assume best/positive intent by everyone, unless proven otherwise.
- I believe in a growth mindset and people who are not willing to grow may find it difficult working with me.
- DIB (Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging) are important for me and I actively try to turn down any biases that I've learned in my life, I expect you hold these values up high as well!
- Open, honest, candid feedback is appreciated. Don't try to sugar coat the feedback or try to be diplomatic. Don't forget: Feedback should be about behavior, not about personal traits.

What I want to earn

I'm always eager to learn about our customers, their challenges, their business goals, patterns across or in specific verticals. I'm pretty sure I haven't even seen the tip of the iceberg yet when it comes to different ways of using our DevSecOps platform, GitLab. I'm curious to see what works, what doesn't, what common (yes, I try to avoid best here) practices are.

Trust is built up over time, but I want to earn your trust. I do appreciate it if you extend trust and give a bit of trust in advance if possible.

Communicating with me

- Quick text messages on Slack work best - I love async communication (avoid naked pings)
- Longer dialogs are preferably carried out via a video conference (ie. Slack Huddle, Zoom, or Google Meet)
- I tend to answer rather quickly on Slack (as an instant messaging platform), but you get no SLA on mails.
- Phone is generally discouraged, but in case something is super-urgent and needs my immediate

attention, phone is fine of course. I may not have your phone number saved; Giving a heads up via SMS is therefore appreciated.

- Be as precise as possible about the expectations when reaching out. Let me know if you're searching for advise, just want someone to listen, looking for feedback, go into a coaching session, etc. And stop me if we divert from the goal/objective set. Push on an additional call with me.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/renewals/index.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Link to Commercial Renewal Process

Overview

A key part of the customer relationship lifecycle is the renewal phase. CSMs must proactively track the renewal dates of their customers and align with their Account Executive (AE) to ensure that a customer renewal takes place.

Timeframe

4 months before the renewal date for a customer, a CTA will trigger in Gainsight to prompt the CSM to reach out to their aligned account team to discuss strategy and next steps for the renewal. The expectation is that the team will meet internally and speak with the customer regarding the renewal within the following 30 days. This leaves three months to execute any renewal strategy, such as an account triage.

Renewal playbook steps

1. Confirm the renewal DRI
1. Renewal Review: Internal sync with SAE/AE and potentially SA as defined below
1. 'Soft' renewal question asked by CSM
1. Update CSM Sentiment as appropriate

Once the above tasks are complete, the playbook and CTA can be closed out as all actionable items have been performed.

Confirm the renewal DRI

For tier 0, 1 and 2 renewals a renewals manager is involved. For the level of ownership the renewals manager takes per tier, please see this tiering section from the renewals manager handbook page.

To determine what tier a renewal opportunity falls within, the CSM can reference the 'Renewal Ownership' field in the Opp, in the 'Opportunity Detail' section.

Renewal review meeting - internal sync

A renewal review meeting should have the following attendees:

- Renewal DRI (AE or RM)
- Customer Success Manager
- Solutions Architect, if an upsell is being discussed

For CSMs with larger books of business, it is appropriate to update an AE or SAE async that they are going to ask the soft renewal question in their next sync, to ensure they are aligned with other conversations that are ensuing.

Soft renewal question

The CSM will ask the initial renewal question, this should be a 'soft' question to see if there is any risk in the account and to provide time to mitigate any risk. An example of this soft question is, "I know you have your renewal coming up in the next few months - how are you feeling about the renewal currently, and are there any changes you are considering that we can prepare for?"

Another good approach is to align this renewal conversation with the customer's budget rounds, typically happening mid-year (june/july). You can then ask the customer if they have foreseen in budget for GitLab Licenses in their next fiscal year.

If the customer indicates any risk of contraction or churn in this conversation, the CSM sets the CSM Sentiment field to red, which then overrides the 'Overall Health' field to red also.

It's important that the CSM asks this question no later than the 30-day window from when the CTA is automatically opened:

- If risk is indicated, 3 months can be enough time remaining to make a meaningful change to outcomes
- If a renewals manager is involved, they will be reaching out the customer about the renewal itself, 10 weeks before the renewal. Being informed, at this time, of renewal risk, will make our approach much more sensitive to the customer scenario.

If the status of the renewal is already known (renewal conversation with SAE or AE has happened, negotiations or contract is in-flight), the CSM can close the renewal CTA selecting the appropriate close reason.

Renewal plan

The action items created from the "Renewal Review" meeting should be incorporated into the CSM customer cadence meetings and into any pending QBRs. The actual renewal plan will be documented by the renewal DRI in the opportunity within Salesforce.

Tracking renewal risk

Please see Customer Health Assessment and Management

Related Processes

Customer Success Escalations Process

SECTION: customer-success/csm/researching-customer-questions/index.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Where to research customer questions

There are several ways you can research customer questions.

Google Search

Often it's easiest to cast a wide net when searching customer questions by doing a Google (or another search engine) search. For example, if a customer is inquiring if GitLab does mobile application scanning, you can search "gitlab mobile application scanning" and see related blog posts, documentation, and GitLab issues related to the topic.

Even if you know the answer lies in GitLab's documentation, using the above search method is convenient to link you directly to where in the documentation to continue your research.

This method works amazingly due to GitLab's Transparency value, where we make as much information public as possible.

Zendesk

Zendesk is a powerful avenue for researching customer questions because every support ticket has been archived and is searchable since GitLab implemented Zendesk many years ago.

If your customer is asking a question, likely, others have asked similar or the same question to our support team. Search Zendesk by keywords from your customer's question to review related tickets. You may need to play around with different keywords until you find support tickets that match your customer's inquiry. Often with a few minutes of researching prior support tickets, you can get a response to your customer quicker than them opening a new support ticket.

Note: If the customer requires troubleshooting, you should notify the customer to open a new support ticket, as each inquiry should be treated as unique. What fixed one customer's problem may not work for another, and the Support Team will perform their troubleshooting process.

Product groups and direction pages

Sometimes it's best to get help from team members working directly in the product area of the question.

How to determine which product group is the right one?

There are a few ways to determine which product group works on which feature.

1. Search within the Product Categories handbook page. On this page, you can do a Command + F search for the feature in question. For example, if the question is on Review Apps, you can do a Command + F search to see that the Review Apps feature is under the Pipeline Security group. If the question is related to our product roadmap, you can review the direction page associated with each product group.

1. Search within the documentation. Let's say you are wondering which product group could help with a question on GitLab's Security Dashboard. If you scroll to the bottom of the page and click View page source, you'll see which product Stage and Group the Security Dashboard rolls up to. In this case, it's the Threat Insights group.

1. You can also determine the right product group by reviewing epics/issues related to the feature. For example, when researching Customizable Roles and Permissions, you see on the right-hand side under labels that Authentication and Authorization is the appropriate group.

How do I contact the product group for help?

After finding the appropriate product group for your question, search Slack for the product group's public Slack channel and post your question.

If it will help to connect your customer with someone in Product directly, provide as much detail as possible in a Collaboration Project issue and @ mention the Product Manager, whom you'll find on the Product Categories page. Ask the Product Manager if someone on their team could assist with the inquiry.

Note: Before involving others, please do your due diligence to research the answer based on the methods provided on this page and remember as part of GitLab's values, we are biased towards asynchronous communication.

Slack

Searching in Slack with keywords to your customer's question is helpful to see if there has been a recent discussion thread you can join. Before posting a new question, search to see if the question has already been answered recently.

GitLab.com top-level group

Searching the GitLab.com top-level group is an excellent way to find related issues that will not appear in a Google search result, often within private collaboration projects.

First, start in the <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/> top-level group. Then, use the top search bar to search for results. For example, if a customer asks questions about Gerrit, a framework for teams to review code, you will type Gerrit and filter on the left side by Issues. You will see discussions GitLab team members and customers have had on the topic to help your research.

Highspot and Google Drive

Highspot provides access to approved customer-facing content, whether a presentation on GitLab Ultimate, competitive intelligence, whitepapers, and more.

Learn more about Highspot at GitLab.

Additionally, searching Google Drive will allow you to see Google Presentations and Google Docs related to your search.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/risk-mitigation/_index.md

Types of Risk

We have identified these as the most common types of risk in an account:

- Cost/Budget
 - Over License
 - Acquisition by larger entity
 - Downsizing (ie, Covid related)
- ROI (the customer doesn't feel they're getting value)
 - Not a priority
 - Lack of a plan
 - Lack of leadership support
- Competitive
- Product (the product does do what they want or meets their needs or isn't mature enough)
- Product Usage (not using features & functionality they've paid for... Ex. Ultimate customer not using Secure)
- Lack of Engagement/Loss of Champion

Discovery into the Risk

It can be beneficial to read back the Command Plan in SFDC and discuss the risk internally with the account team on original reasons for purchase. Then check back with the customers if these original value drivers still apply and if they still align with company goals. Use our Command of the Message to find additional discovery questions.

Based on the identified type of risk, the CSM can use some of the following questions to dig a bit deeper into the risk, that may help identify mitigation options:

Cost/Budget

- Over License
 - Do you know how to regularly prune inactive users?
 - Are you aware of our "User Cap" functionality?
 - For Ultimate: Are you aware of our "Guest Users" functionality?
- Acquisition by larger entity
 - What is the integration plan and timeline with the new entity?
 - Will you be required to adopt their toolchain?
 - Do they have any existing master service agreements (MSA's) in place that you'll be

required to follow?

- What tools does the new entity use?
- Downsizing (ie, Layoffs)
 - Do you anticipate a re-hiring of laid-off workers? If so, what's the timeline?
- What's your fiscal year?
- Have you budgeted for a certain number of users?
- Do you have a growth plan for adding users over time?
- Do you understand our licensing (ie, true-ups)?

ROI (the customer doesn't feel they're getting value)

- Not a priority / Lack of leadership support
 - What are your DevOps priorities? How can we align with those?
- Lack of a plan
 - How can we help you adopt greater use and derive greater value from GitLab?
- Where do you feel you're getting the most value out of GitLab right now?
- Where do you feel you're getting the least value out of GitLab right now?

Competitive

- Where do you feel other products are stronger or provide more value than GitLab?
- Is this a pricing issue or a feature issue?

Product (the product does do what they want or meets their needs or isn't mature enough)

- Have you worked with your CSM on a prioritized list of features?
- What feature(s) do you need right now to continue using GitLab?
- Where do you see more opportunity to replace other tools if GitLab was more mature?

Product Usage (not using features & functionality in their license tier)

Ultimate Customer not using Secure

We should generally begin by presenting our DevSecOps Maturity Score demonstrating to the customer their current usage of GitLab Secure. Once they understand the level to which they're using Secure, we can dig a bit deeper with some discovery questions:

1. What kind of security tests are mandated or recommended within your organization?
 - If they give any answer related to 3rd party products, just to question 2.
 - If they say "nothing is mandated/recommended", ask "why".
 - Adoption is shown to increase dramatically when leadership has bought into the solution and mandates usage.
1. What tools are you using to meet those mandates?
 - Third-party or custom-built in-house solutions?
 - Are those specific tools mandated or do teams have the freedom to choose what they use?
1. Does your organization have a concrete shift-left or DevSecOps initiative in play?
 - If "Yes"... "Tell me about that in terms of tooling and timelines."
1. Are you aware that you can enforce compliance and security testing at the group level using our compliance frameworks?
 - If they say "No", arrange for enablement around compliance frameworks.

- If they say "Yes", follow up with "Are you using them to ensure security compliance?"

Customer not using CI

We should generally begin by presenting our CI Maturity Score demonstrating to the customer their current usage of GitLab CI if they are using CI to some degree. Once we understand how many users (if any) are using CI today, we can then dig a bit deeper with some discovery questions:

- What are users currently using as CI tool?
 - Users can still use other products for CI. Offer to help them migrate.
- Why aren't users moving to GitLab CI?
- What is blocking users to adopt CI pipelines in GitLab?
 - Lack of knowledge is often a blocker for CI adoption
- How can we support you in improving adoption?

Customers may also be stuck on topics around the migration off of other tools, developer sentiment, lack of buy-in or other areas of challenge. Please reference the CI Landing Zone for training and content addressing these challenges.

Lack of Engagement/Loss of Champion

- Who is in charge of maintaining GitLab going forward?
- Is there someone in your organization in charge of tool adoption or change management?

Mitigation

Once we know the risk and done some discovery into that risk, we have some options available to help mitigate that risk:

Cost/Budget

- Explore cloud provider retiring spend
 - Lots of company's have minimum amounts they have to spend on the cloud every year to continue receiving discounts. They can use that spend on GitLab and we only take a 3% haircut to the cloud provider, but its better than 100% churn.
- Help identify other redundant tools that GitLab can replace.
 - Good areas to target are CI/CD tools, Package tools (eg. Artifactory) and Security tooling

ROI

- This can be used as part of the cost/budget risk mitigation strategy.
- Product Marketing has been helpful in putting together generic ROI decks that can be tailored to a specific customer.
- Our marketing page has an ROI calculator: <https://about.gitlab.com/calculator/>

Competitive

- Product Marketing has numerous battle cards based on the competitor linked in our handbook.
- Seek help in the competition Slack channel

- It's very important to determine the "why this competitor" instead of the "who is the competitor". The why is usually a cost or feature/functionality disparity. This will also help determine mitigation.

Product

- Based on the discovery questions, identify the gaps.
- If it's a maturity problem, each product Stage has a roadmap page in the handbook. Product Managers are also generally very happy to get on a call with a customer to discuss the roadmap and to listen to the customer's needs and wants.
- If it's a functionality gap, make sure that you've identified all the gaps and added the customer to the relevant issues using the Product Feedback Template. It's also a good opportunity to get a PM on a call with the customer to help advocate for these issues and get them on the roadmap.

Product Usage (not using features & functionality in their license tier)

Ultimate Customer not using Secure

- Offer a Secure Workshop if they don't understand the value of GitLab Secure.
- Present our DevSecOps Adoption Path [Internal Link] to a Development Team Lead to help guide the customer to adopting GitLab Secure functionality. Presenting to the right persona is critical as they have the influence to enact/enforce the adoption path recommendations
- Try to identify teams who are willing to test out Secure functionality at a small scale
- Try to engage with the Security team to find out what policies aren't being followed
- Try to engage with the Economic Buyer and let them know of the lack of adoption (through a DevSecOps Maturity Score presentation) and your concerns
 - Encourage them to implement a top-down mandate to use more GitLab Secure
- Track adoption progress during cadence calls by presenting updated DevSecOps Maturity Scores and trend patterns

Customer not using CI

- Offer an Advanced CI/CD workshop if they have difficulty in building pipelines.
- Work with the GitLab team to build CI/CD templates for certain jobs and pipelines to make it easier for users to adopt CI.
- If it is a migration problem, work with the customer on tutorials to do a migration
 - Try to identify teams who are willing to work with you on their pipeline
 - Extract templates out of the teams pipeline to share to the broader audience
 - Run AMA sessions with the customer to answer any pipeline questions.

Lack of engagement/Loss of champion

- For lack of engagement, please see our Strategies for Non-Engaged Customers handbook page.
- For a loss of champion, the CSM and their sales counterpart are to proactively seek out and establish new champions
 - Identify who's replacing your champion and cultivate that relationship.
 - Find someone who loves GitLab and include them in future calls (if they aren't already).
 - CSMs should be quick to loop in GitLab executive contacts to reach out to the customer at the highest levels.

- Even if a champion leaves, there's still going to be someone in a position of authority who can advocate for us. Find that person.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/risk-mitigation/self-managed-vs-saas.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Moving to SaaS From Self-Managed

Many customers are interested in migrating to our SaaS platform. Typically their reasons for doing so are:

- Infrastructure Cost Savings
 - They do not need to pay for infrastructure to host their GitLab instance, or employees to manage this infrastructure
- Mitigate Administration Issues
 - Customers do not necessarily want to manage being a GitLab admin
- Have Latest Features
 - Customers will always be on the latest version of GitLab
 - Don't need to perform upgrades
 - Always up to date

If a customer poses an interest in moving to SaaS, it is important that they know the differences between the two platforms: namely, the presence or absence of administrative control. On self-managed, Admin users can access the Admin Panel, and have the ability to impersonate users, remove personal access tokens created by users, and make use of other features only Admins can use. On SaaS, users have more control and there are no Admins, thus, there is less access control. Also, some APIs cannot be used on SaaS, as they require the user conducting the request to have administrative privileges.

Process For Moving a Customer From Self-Managed to SaaS

1. Identify decision-maker for moving to SaaS
1. Optional: Identify security team contact
1. Ask Discovery Questions on cadence call
1. Suggest a Self Managed vs. SaaS comparison discussion on next cadence call